assertion that ‘Journalist’s Snowden-like revelations about 1962 war boost China’s claims on peaceful rise’.[20]

One would need to have a lot of imagination to conclude from the Henderson Brooks–Bhagat Report that India was the aggressor and China the aggrieved party in 1962. The question of who attacked whom, or determining who was responsible for the war, was not even within the scope of the enquiry, which had been set up to look into four specific aspects of the war that could explain the Indian defeat: possible shortcomings in training and equipment; the system of command; the physical fitness of the troops; and the capacity of commanders at all levels to influence their subordinates.[21]

In essence, the Henderson Brooks–Bhagat Report states little more than that India was ill prepared for the war and therefore unable to withstand the Chinese assault over the Himalayas. It also points out weaknesses in India’s command structure, and the lack of effective co-operation between the government and the military. It certainly does not say that India was responsible for the war, nor does it question the Forward Policy per se.[22]

After Maxwell made the report public and it became clear that it was not, after all, that exciting, many Indian journalists and researchers began to speculate whether there was also a second report or an appendix to the first which would reveal more. But, to the disappointment of many, there is not as much to the report as Maxwell and others have claimed. Or, as B.G. Verghese, a former assistant editor of *The Times of India*, wrote in 2012, ‘The report brings out the political and military naiveté, muddle, contradictions and in-fighting that prevailed and failures of planning and control. There is no military secret to protect in the Henderson Brooks report; only political and military ego and folly to hide.’[23] When I began to scrutinize the footnotes in *India’s China War*, I also found discrepancies between what Maxwell wrote and what the sources in the footnotes actually said.

After reading Maxwell, I turned to the writings of the British academic Alastair Lamb, who has written profusely about the border disputes between India and China, and India and Pakistan. While Lamb’s books and articles are much more scholarly than Maxwell’s writings on the border issue and the 1962 War, there are serious shortcomings and justifiable criticisms to make even there. Leo E. Rose, professor of Political Science